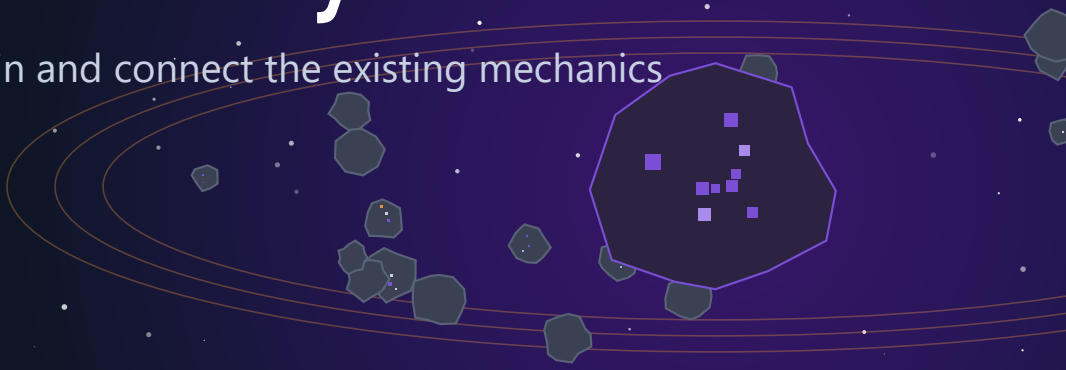
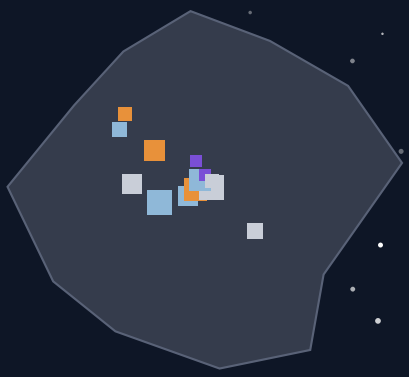
SPACEBOX / DESIGN IDEAS

Echoes of Veyra

Lore ideas that explain and connect the existing mechanics







Proposal document, game version 0.1.5 · October 2026

Nothing in this document is in the game yet. All names are working titles.

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How to read this

This document proposes a story world for Spacebox. It does not add new systems for their own sake: every lore element is chosen because it **explains something the game already does** (oxygen, gravity, the DNA reconstructor, mineral parasites, the drifting spacer bodies, claim beacons, the asteroid-only universe) or because it can be delivered through something the game already has or can get cheaply (tutorial texts, descriptions, signs, info panels, picture frames, loot tables, the reconstruction screen).

Sections 1 and 2 are the analysis and three alternative directions. Sections 3 to 9 develop the recommended direction, **Echoes of Veyra**, in full. Sections 10 to 12 are ready-to-paste content hooks and an implementation order.

STARTING POINT

1. What the game already says

Spacebox has no written story yet, but its systems already tell one. Before inventing anything, here is what a player can observe in version 0.1.5, and the question each observation raises. A good lore answers these questions instead of adding unrelated ones.

Observation in the game	Where it comes from	Question it raises
You start alone on an asteroid with an aluminium drill, a furnace, a crafting table and a weak flashlight.	config.json ItemsOnStart; spawn on a rock asteroid	Who are you, who packed this kit, and why is nobody else here?
The universe is an endless belt of asteroids. No planets, no star system to land on.	WorldGenerator, biomes Asteroid Field and Dense Cluster	Where did all these rocks come from?
Rock comes in layers: light, medium and heavy rock, ice with water, dense ice with methane, ore veins.	blocks.json minerals, asteroid layers	Why do asteroids look like slices of something bigger?
You consume oxygen and power; oxygen comes from ice through water.	OxygenConsumeInterval, compressed oxygen, oxygen generator	Why is there water ice everywhere?
Artificial gravity needs obscurium, an extremely rare ore with strange properties.	Gravity Generator recipe, Obscurium Ore description	What is obscurium, and why does it bend gravity?
Death is not the end: a DNA reconstructor grows a new body from a DNA sample made from your own health.	dna_sample recipe uses $health; reconstruction screen stages	Is the revived player still the same person? Who invented this?
Without a reconstructor you reappear at the spawn point.	PlayerRespawner.RespawnAtSpawnPoint	What is at the spawn point that can rebuild you?
Mineral parasites live only in the dark, eat natural asteroid rock, get hungry when a player is near, die in violet sparks.	Mobs/mineral_parasite.json, spawn rules	Where do they come from and why do they react to you?
Dead astronauts (spacers) drift between rocks with a med kit, water, a pistol and always some beer.	Loot/spacer.json, Spacer.cs	Who were they? Why the beer?
Ship guns are called Anti-Corvette and Anti-Frigate.	blocks.json cannons	Who flew corvettes and frigates here?
A claim beacon protects your base while it is paid with ingots.	Claim Beacon	Paid to whom?
Structure files for an abandoned ship, an alien base and ruins exist but are still empty.	Generation/Structures	Planned content: needs a reason to exist.
Thirty pictures: Ringed Planet, Twin Moons, Lone Beacon, The Door, Orbital Station, Old Terminal, Parasite Hunt, Star Whale…	Pictures, picture items	Memories of a world that is gone?

Observation in the game	Where it comes from	Question it raises
Beer: 'Was added accidentally'. Moritz: 'A friendly face in space'.	items.json, blocks.json	The game has a dry sense of humour. Keep it.

Design goals for the lore

- **Explain, do not decorate.** Each lore pillar must justify at least one mechanic (see the mapping in section 5).
- **Sandbox first.** No forced story, no cutscenes. Lore is found, read and connected by the curious player; ignoring it costs nothing.
- **Works in single player and multiplayer.** The setting must explain why you are alone and also why other players may appear.
- **Cheap to deliver.** Text in JSON, signs, pictures and loot tables before any new system. Respect the existing rules: descriptions are short and contain no numbers.
- **Room to grow.** Leave hooks for the empty structure files (abandoned ship, alien base, ruins), for a possible planets scene, and for new GameSets and mods.
- **Tone:** lonely and a bit eerie, but with the dry workplace humour the game already has (beer, Moritz).

OPTIONS

2. Three lore directions

Three directions that all fit the current game. They differ in how much mystery they promise, how much new content they need, and how well they explain the existing systems.

A. The Last Shift

Grounded, corporate, comedic. The belt is a natural asteroid belt in a remote system. A mining contractor worked it until prices crashed and the company evacuated in a hurry. You are a contract miner who missed the last shuttle (you were asleep in a storage crate after the farewell party, hence the beer). The company's automated systems still run: reconstructors keep workers productive, the claims office keeps billing. The goal is to earn enough to buy a ticket home, or to decide you like it here.

Pros	Cons
Simplest to write and deliver. Fits the beer, Moritz, claim beacon and starting kit perfectly. No aliens to model. Humour is easy.	Weak mystery: nothing to discover in the dark. Does not explain obscurium, parasites or the layered asteroids. The ending (buy a ticket) is a trade goal, not an adventure. Little use for alien base and ruins.

B. Echoes of Veyra (recommended)

Shattered world, quiet tragedy, slow mystery. The belt was once a planet, Veyra, with two moons. A mining corporation drilled for obscurium, a gravity-bending mineral, in the planet's core, and the planet broke apart. Its automated systems never stopped. You are a worker reconstructed from an old DNA archive by an emergency pod, centuries later, with a starter kit and an onboarding AI. Parasites are the native life of the deep crust. The spacers are dead workers, some of them earlier copies of you. Older alien ruins inside the heaviest rocks suggest the planet was never just a planet.

Pros	Cons
Explains almost every mechanic: layered rock, ice, obscurium and gravity, the DNA reconstructor, respawn at the spawn point, parasites, spacers, claim beacons, ship guns, the pictures. Strong mysteries with a clear long-term goal. Works in multiplayer (every player is another echo). Keeps the humour in the corporate leftovers.	Needs some discipline to stay consistent (dates, names). The deepest reveals need the planned structures (derelicts, ruins) to land well. A sad core theme must be balanced by the dry humour.

C. The Seed Vault

Far future, cosmic, post-human. Humanity is gone. An automated seed ark arrived at an unfinished alien megastructure, a swarm of hollowed asteroids built around a star by a vanished species. The ark prints colonists from its gene vault, one at a time, to finish what the builders started. The parasites are the builders' maintenance organisms gone feral. Obscurium is builder technology. The ending is switching the megastructure on.

Pros	Cons
Grand scale and a big final goal. Strong reason for printed bodies. Lots of room for alien architecture and future content.	Clashes with the retro-human tone (beer, cassette tape, floppy disk, neon pictures, ship guns named after warships). Needs a lot of alien content before it pays off. Does not explain why asteroids contain natural ice, methane and ore veins in layers.

Comparison

Criterion	A. Last Shift	B. Echoes of Veyra	C. Seed Vault
Explains existing mechanics	Partly	**Almost all**	Partly
Mystery and discovery	Low	**High**	High
Fits the current tone and art	**Very well**	Well	Weak
Content needed before it pays off	**Very little**	Little to medium	A lot
Multiplayer explanation	Other late workers	**Other echoes from the archive**	Other printed colonists
Long-term goal / ending	Buy a ticket home	**Reach the Heart, choose an ending**	Switch the structure on
Use for alien base and ruins	None	**Yes, as a late reveal**	Core of the story

Recommendation

Take **B** as the backbone and keep the voice of **A** for everything the corporation left behind: memos, labels, the onboarding AI, the claims office, the beer. Borrow one idea from **C** as the deepest, optional mystery: Veyra was older and stranger than its miners knew. The rest of this document develops this combination.

RECOMMENDED DIRECTION

3. Echoes of Veyra: the world

> *Every worker on Veyra is insured against death. Your body is company property; your mind is your own. Please keep your DNA sample current.*
>
> Kestrel Deepworks, employee handbook, chapter one

The pitch in five sentences

- The belt you live in was once **Veyra**, a dense rocky world with oceans, a thin methane sky and two moons, orbiting an orange star called **Ardent**.
- The mining corporation **Kestrel Deepworks** found **obscurium** in its crust, a mineral whose mass leans: it bends gravity around itself. Kestrel built its fortune on gravity plates.
- To reach the richest obscurium, Kestrel drilled into the core. The core answered. In one day, remembered as **the Sundering**, Veyra and both moons broke into the belt you see now.
- Kestrel's automated systems never stopped. Centuries later an emergency pod, a **Cradle**, grows one more worker from its damaged DNA archive and wakes them with a starter kit and an onboarding AI. That worker is you.
- You are not the first one it woke. Somewhere near the centre of the belt, where the obscurium is densest, something is still pulling the pieces together.

Why this belt has no planets

Because the planet is the belt. This turns the procedural generation into storytelling: the asteroid types are literally layers of a dead world.

In the game	In the lore
Light rock (soft, outer layers, easy to mine)	Veyra's crust and regolith.
Medium rock, heavy rock (dense, needs strong drills)	Upper and deep mantle. Heavy asteroids are chunks from close to the core.
Icy asteroids with water ice	Veyra's frozen oceans. Every glass of water and every breath of oxygen you make is old sea water.
Dense ice with methane	The frozen remains of Veyra's atmosphere and polar caps.
Ore veins: aluminium, iron, cobaltite, titanium, thulium, uranium	Ordinary planetary geology, now open to the void.
Obscurium: extremely rare, deep inside medium and heavy asteroids	Splinters of the core. They still hold nearby rocks loosely together, which is why asteroids cluster.
Dense Cluster biome, a certain distance from the centre	**The Crush**: the inner ring where the core fragments are bigger and rocks are packed tight.
Asteroid Field biome	**The Shallows**: the scattered outer belt, safest for a new worker.
Debug 'cheese' asteroid full of every ore	An easter egg: Kestrel test core sample, filed as *Specimen C, do not eat*.

Obscurium, the key mineral

Obscurium is the thread that ties the endgame together. In the lore it is a dark violet mineral that **bends gravity** in proportion to how much energy runs through it. Unpowered, it only nudges rocks over centuries. Powered, it makes a floor feel like a planet. This explains in one stroke why the gravity generator needs obscurium ingots and power, why it starts switched off, why the obscurium drill 'mines anything' (the bit bends the rock's own cohesion), and why the violet colour shows up in parasite death sparks.

What death means

Death is a business process. Kestrel insured its workers by keeping their DNA and a current body pattern. A **DNA reconstructor** is a field version of the same machine: it reads a DNA sample and grows a new body in stages (the reconstruction screen already shows them: sequencing DNA, skeleton, muscle, nervous system and skin). The sample is made from a med kit, water, glass and your own blood (the recipe costs health), so every reconstruction literally needs a piece of you.

Without a reconstructor you wake again at the **Cradle**, the emergency pod where you first woke. That is the spawn point. The Cradle has the original scan, but it is slow and old and far from your base, which is why building your own reconstructor is worth it.

> **The quiet question**
>
> Are you the same person after reconstruction? The game never answers. The Cradle counts your reconstructions, the drifting spacers wear your suit model, and one of them carries your employee number. Players draw their own conclusion.

HISTORY

4. Timeline

Years are given in Kestrel Years (KY), counted from the first survey. Exact numbers are working values; only the order matters.

When	Event	What it explains today
Unknown, very old	Something builds chambers deep inside Veyra's core and seals them. The planet forms around, or is shaped around, a mass of obscurium.	Alien ruins and the alien base structure, alien chests, the deepest mystery.
KY 0	Kestrel Deepworks surveys Ardent's system and finds obscurium in Veyra's crust.	Obscurium as the reason anyone came here.
KY 12	First mining colony, **Lowlight**, founded. Every employee signs the *Continuity Charter*: DNA is archived, death is covered, bodies are company property.	The DNA reconstructor; DNA samples; the Cradle archive.
KY 20 to 40	Gravity plates built from obscurium sell across settled space. Habitat kits, oxygen generators fed by ocean ice, standard crafting tables and furnaces are mass produced.	Oxygen and gravity generators, the starter kit, the furnace and crafting table design.
KY 31	Deep shafts report 'rockmites': animals that eat stone and hate light. Shafts are sealed and lit.	Mineral parasites, their fear of light, the larva item (lab specimen).

When	Event	What it explains today
KY 52	A cargo manifest error delivers forty thousand crates of Kestrel Lager instead of oxygen candles. The beer becomes the colony's unofficial currency.	Beer in every spacer's pockets; 'was added accidentally'.
KY 58 to 61	**Charter War.** Colonists of the **Free Veyran Compact** demand ownership of their reconstructed bodies. Kestrel arms its haulers. Corvettes and frigates fight over the moons.	Ship guns named Anti-Corvette and Anti-Frigate; wrecks; bombs.
KY 64	The **Deep Tap** project starts: a bore to the core to feed a gravity drive, called **the Door**, meant to fold ships across the stars.	The picture 'The Door'; the endgame goal.
KY 71	**The Sundering.** The core inverts its pull. Veyra and both moons break apart within one day. Most of the colony dies at once.	The belt, the spacers, the layered asteroids, the empty space where planets should be.
KY 71 to 80	Kestrel's automated systems keep running: Cradles keep reconstructing workers for salvage, the Claims Registry keeps billing. Kestrel's signal from home stops. Nobody knows why.	Claim beacons paid in ingots; the onboarding AI; respawn at the Cradle.
Centuries pass	Fragments drift into a wide belt. Oceans freeze. Parasites spread through dark cavities and breed. Cradles fail one by one.	Icy asteroids, parasite spawning in unlit cavities.
Now	One last Cradle with a damaged archive wakes a worker with the basic Reclamation Kit. The onboarding AI boots and starts the tutorial.	The new game.

CORE MAPPING

5. Mechanics and their lore

This is the central table of the proposal. Every row is an existing system and the in-world reason for it.

Mechanic	In-world explanation
Spawning alone with a basic kit	You are a reconstructed worker from a Cradle. The Cradle only stocks the cheapest **Kestrel Reclamation Kit**: aluminium drill, furnace, crafting table, aluminium flashlight. Cost cutting is a running joke.
Tutorial	Spoken by **FOREMAN**, Kestrel's onboarding AI inside your suit. It still thinks it is training a new hire for a normal shift.
Zero gravity, rolling, flashlight	Veyra's pieces are too small to hold you. Asteroids are dark inside because they were the inside of a planet.
Oxygen bar, ice to water to oxygen	Suits are sealed but not self-sufficient. Water comes from frozen ocean ice.
Power bar, drilling uses power, power packs, power generator equipment	Every tool runs on the suit's cell. Hydrogen from water feeds overcharge packs, an old miners' trick.

Mechanic	In-world explanation
Drill tiers and ore hardness	Deeper layers of the dead planet need better drills. Progress from crust to core mirrors progress through the tech tree.
Furnace, crusher, disassembler, pipes	Standard Kestrel machinery. Disassembly is salvage, the reason Cradles woke workers in the first place.
Oxygen generator	Kestrel habitat kit. Fills a sealed room from ice water. Stops when the room leaks, as safety rules require.
Gravity generator (needs obscurium, starts off)	Kestrel's flagship product: a powered obscurium plate. Ships off by default because a surprise floor has killed many workers.
DNA sample (costs health) and DNA reconstructor	Field version of the Continuity Charter machines. The sample is your blood and a med kit's culture medium in a glass vial.
Respawn at the spawn point without a reconstructor	The Cradle reconstructs you from its original archive scan. Slow, far away, and it keeps count.
Mineral parasites	Native lithovores from Veyra's deep crust. They eat stone, live in total dark and sense bioelectric fields: a powered suit nearby wakes their hunger. Violet sparks are obscurium in their bodies.
Spacers (drifting bodies with loot)	Dead workers from the Sundering and from later Cradle cycles. They carry Charter-issue med kits, water, a sidearm, and beer.
Claim beacon paid with ingots	Kestrel's **Claims Registry** is still online. It accepts metal as payment and protects registered sites. Where the ingots go is a mystery.
Radar, ore scanner	Survey equipment. Later: the radar picks up old beacons and derelict signals.
Ships, thrusters, consoles, ship cameras	Any structure in open space can be a ship because Kestrel designed modular hulls for salvage crews.
Ship guns named after warship classes, bombs	Leftover designs from the Charter War.
Nuclear power blocks explode when destroyed	Wartime reactor designs with no safety margin. FOREMAN disapproves.
Signs, info panels, picture frames, pictures	Things people leave behind. Pictures are memories of Veyra and of home.
Multiplayer, PvP, claims	Other players are other **echoes** woken by other Cradles. Some cooperate, some fight, the Registry stays neutral.
Moritz	Kestrel's mascot, a grinning prospector on safety posters. Crafting a Moritz statue is a tradition among old crews.

WHO IS (OR WAS) OUT THERE

6. Factions and remnants

No faction is a living army waiting for you. They are traces, systems and survivors that tell the story through what they left.

Kestrel Deepworks (gone, automated)

The corporation. Polite, cheap, cheerful and slightly inhuman. Present through FOREMAN, the Cradles, the Claims Registry, labels on machines, memos and safety posters. Its silence after the Sundering is one of the mysteries.

FOREMAN (onboarding AI)

Your suit's tutorial voice. Friendly, procedural, always quoting the handbook. Late in the game its records turn out to be incomplete, and it starts asking you questions.

The Echoes (players)

Workers reconstructed from Cradle archives. In single player you are the only one awake. In multiplayer each player is another echo, possibly from a different archive. The Registry treats you all the same.

Free Veyran Compact (dead)

The colonists who fought for ownership of their bodies. Their wrecked corvettes and frigates, slogans painted on hulls and coded logs are the best source of truth about Kestrel.

Lithovores (mineral parasites)

Native life of the deep crust. Not evil, just hungry. They eat rock, avoid light and sense power. Kestrel biologists kept larvae for study. A larger form may live in the Crush.

The Builders (unknown)

Whoever made the sealed chambers inside the core long before Kestrel. Never seen. Their ruins hold alien chests and a script nobody can read. Optional deepest layer of the lore.

How factions show up in play

Faction	Existing hook	Cheap new hook
Kestrel	Starter kit, claim beacon, machines	Memos on info panels in derelicts, a Lore line in tooltips, the reconstruction screen header
FOREMAN	Tutorial panel texts	One-line chat messages on milestones (first obscurium, first death, first parasite)
Echoes	Multiplayer join, player names	Server join message 'Another echo has woken', Cradle counter on the death screen
Compact	Anti-Corvette and Anti-Frigate guns, bombs	Abandoned ship structure with Compact paint, signs and a log
Lithovores	Mineral parasite, larva item, picture 'Parasite Hunt'	Lore line on the larva, a biologist log in a derelict lab
Builders	Alien base and ruins structure files, alien chest loot table	Violet-lit chambers inside heavy asteroids, an unreadable info panel

GEOGRAPHY

7. Locations in the belt

Locations are built from what the generator already makes (biomes, asteroid types, distance from the centre) plus the planned structures.

The Cradle (spawn point)
Where you first wake and where you return without a reconstructor. Today it is just a rock. Cheap upgrade: a small derelict pod structure at the spawn with an info panel and a picture frame.

The Shallows (Asteroid Field)
The scattered outer belt. Light and medium rock, the safest place to learn. Few parasites because the rocks are small.

Icefall (icy asteroids)
Frozen oceans of Veyra. Water and methane. Good spots for derelict pumping stations of the old colony.

The Crush (Dense Cluster)
The inner ring with packed rocks and bigger core fragments. Rich ore, more obscurium, more darkness, more parasites. Wrecks of the Charter War drift here.

Derelict lanes (abandoned_ship)
Lines of wrecked haulers and Compact corvettes. Signs, logs, crates and a chance of weapon blueprints. Ship-sized salvage for the disassembler.

Lowlight ruins (ruins)
Fragments of the colony: habitat rooms with dead oxygen generators, doors, info panels, picture frames with family pictures. Teaches by example what a base looks like.

Builder chambers (alien_base)
Sealed violet-lit rooms deep inside heavy asteroids. Unknown script, alien chests. Reachable only with strong drills: a natural late-game gate.

The Heart (belt centre)
The largest surviving core fragment. Gravity is strange here, obscurium is everywhere, and the Door bore is still open. The endgame location.

THINGS TO DISCOVER

8. Mysteries and the ending

Mysteries are questions the player can notice on their own. Each has a trail of clues and a payoff; none is required to play.

Mystery	First clue (cheap)	Payoff
Who am I?	The reconstruction screen shows an employee number and a reconstruction counter.	A spacer carries a tag with the same number. Logs show the Cradle has woken this worker many times.
Why are the spacers so similar?	All spacers use the same suit model and the same loot.	They are earlier Cradle cycles. The Cradle only wakes a new copy when the last one stops sending life signs.
Why do parasites wake up when I come close?	Their hunger grows with player distance (already in the game).	They feed on the bioelectric field of powered suits. Reconstructed bodies carry traces of obscurium from the Cradle, which makes you taste like the core.

Mystery	First clue (cheap)	Payoff
Where do the claim ingots go?	The claim beacon takes ingots and protects your base.	A Registry relay in the Crush still forwards payments to a Kestrel account. Late log: the account is still active, and someone is still withdrawing.
Why did Kestrel go silent?	No signal on the radar beyond the belt.	Kept open on purpose. Possible answers: the Door opened somewhere else, or home was hit by the same failure.
What is the Door?	The picture 'The Door' and 'Lone Beacon'.	The gravity drive at the bottom of the Deep Tap bore in the Heart.
Was the Sundering an accident?	Builder chambers are older than the colony.	The Builders sealed something in the core. Drilling did not break the planet; it opened the lock.
The beer	'Was added accidentally.'	A manifest log from KY 52. Pure comedy, rewards curiosity.

A sandbox-friendly ending

Spacebox is a sandbox, so the ending should be a long-term project the player chooses, not a final level. Proposal: a hidden **Chronicle** chapter (same system as the tutorial, shown only after the basics are done) that leads to the Heart and ends with one of three expensive constructions.

Seal the Heart

Build a ring of powered gravity generators around the core fragment. The belt stops spreading. Reward: a permanent calm zone and a Kestrel 'employee of the century' plaque.

Open the Door

Repair the Deep Tap drive with obscurium and nuclear power. A jump to an unknown place. Natural entry point for a future planet scene or a new GameSet.

Call home

Rebuild the long-range relay from the Lone Beacon picture. The answer is left ambiguous, a message that can be updated in later versions.

CHANNELS

9. Delivering lore in the game

The rule: use what exists, add small generic features before special ones. Costs: **S** is a JSON or text change, **M** is a small code feature reusing existing UI, **L** is a new system.

Channel	What exists today	Lore use	Cost
Tutorial panel	basics.json chapters with Title, Text, Hint	FOREMAN voice in chapter intros and a few step texts. Must still teach the mechanic; keep {key:...} tokens; tutorial tests stay green.	S
Item and block descriptions	Description: short, no digits (DefaultDescriptionsTests)	Keep descriptions functional. Add an optional **Lore** field (default empty, old GameSets still load) shown as a grey italic line in the tooltip.	S to M
Picture items	Thirty pictures with names, picture tooltips	A Lore line per picture turns them into memories of Veyra.	S

Channel	What exists today	Lore use	Cost
Spacer loot	Loot/spacer.json	Add data tapes (plain items with Lore text), employee tags, a Kestrel Lager label.	S
Signs and info panels	Sign blocks with saved text, glowing info panel	Pre-placed signs in derelict structures: memos, graffiti, warnings.	M, needs structures
Picture frames	Frames that hold pictures	Family pictures in Lowlight ruins, Compact propaganda in wrecks.	M, needs structures
Structures	abandoned_ship, alien_base, ruins (empty files)	The main environmental storytelling channel: derelicts, ruins, Builder chambers.	M to L
Reconstruction screen	DnaReconstructionScreen stage lines	Header 'SUBJECT KD-xxxx, RECONSTRUCTION n' from the player's death count.	S
Death screen	'YOU DIED', Respawn, Reconstruct from DNA	Rename Respawn to 'Return to Cradle'; add a short random line under the title.	S
Welcome screen	WelcomeUI dev message	Add a short in-world memo above the dev note (FOREMAN boot text).	S
Loading screen	'Loading world', progress lines	A rotating tip or quote line from the handbook.	S
Chat / toasts	Chat, tutorial toasts, PlayerActivity events	FOREMAN one-liners on milestones, reusing tutorial event hooks.	M
Claim beacon window	Claim UI with ingot payments	Header 'Kestrel Claims Registry', receipt-style text.	S
Radar	Radar block and equipment	Derelict signals as faint markers ('unknown signal').	M
Readable items	None	A 'log' item type that opens a text window, plus a Journal tab collecting found logs.	L
Multiplayer	Join messages, server name, dashboard	'Another echo has woken: name' on join. Server MOTD template.	S

Compatibility notes

All new JSON fields need defaults so old GameSets load (project rule). New items in loot tables are additive and need no world upgrade. If any item or block id is renamed for lore reasons, it needs a world upgrade step. Tutorials must keep teaching the real mechanics.

READY TO PASTE

10. Content hooks: items and blocks

Proposed text for an optional **Lore** line. All lines follow the description rule (short, no digits) so the same test can cover them. Existing Description texts stay as they are.

Id	Lore line
aluminium_drill	Kestrel Reclamation Kit, model one. Cheap, light, and covered by a warranty that expired centuries ago.
furnace	Standard issue. The label says: do not smelt anything that is still moving.
crafting_table	Kestrel Field Fabricator. Knows every blueprint you are cleared for, and a few you are not.
aluminium_flashlight	Parasites hate it. Keep it on.
light_rock	Crust of Veyra. Somebody once grew gardens in this.
heavy_rock	Deep mantle. The closer to the core, the harder the rock.
ice_rock	Frozen sea water. Veyra had oceans once.
dense_ice_rock	What is left of the sky, frozen solid.
obscurium_ore	A splinter of the core. Its weight leans toward things that are not there.
obscurium_ingot	Warm to the touch. Rocks drift toward the furnace when you smelt it.
obscurium_drill	It does not cut rock. It convinces rock to let go.
water	Old ocean water from Veyra. Filtered twice, just to be sure.
compressed_oxygen	Breathe the sea of a dead planet.
beer	Kestrel Lager. Forty thousand crates, one decimal error. Still the best currency in the belt.
med_kit	Charter issue. The culture gel inside also feeds DNA samples.
dna_sample	A vial of your blood. Keep it close to a reconstructor and death becomes a delay.
dna_reconstructor	Continuity Charter field unit. Your body is company property; your mind is your own.
oxygen_generator	Habitat kit. Shuts down when the room leaks, as safety rules require.
gravity_generator	Kestrel's flagship product. Ships switched off, because surprise floors kill.
claim_beacon	Connects to the Kestrel Claims Registry. Payment accepted. Recipient unknown.
radar	Survey radar. Some of the signals it hears are very old.
analyzer	Core survey scanner. Reads an asteroid like a page torn out of a planet.
standard_nuclear_power_block	Charter War reactor design. No margin, no apologies.
cannon_anticorvette	Built to stop Compact corvettes. Works just as well on rocks.
cannon_antifrigate	The last argument of the Charter War.

Id	Lore line
ship_console	Modular salvage hull standard: anything with a console and thrusters is a ship.
mineral_parasite_spawner	Lab specimen, Kestrel biology deck. Do not feed. Do not name.
moritz	Kestrel's mascot. Crews build one for luck before a deep dive.
cobalt_bomb	Mining charge. The handbook calls it a last resort; miners call it Tuesday.
repair_tool	Everything breaks out here. This is why the belt still stands.

Picture memories

Picture	Lore line
Twin Moons	Veyra's two moons, Hale and Little Hale, before the Sundering.
Ringed Planet	A postcard from home, wherever that was.
Lone Beacon	The long relay at the edge of the belt. It still blinks.
The Door	Deep Tap project poster. Through here, the stars.
Orbital Station	Lowlight Station, shift change at dawn.
Old Terminal	FOREMAN's first terminal, back when it had a face.
Parasite Hunt	Shaft crews used to bet beer on these hunts.
Astronaut	Employee of the month. Every month. Same face.
Asteroid Belt	This used to be a planet.
Star Whale	A miner's tall tale from the Crush. Nobody admits seeing it.
Black Hole	What the Heart looks like on a bad day.
Floppy Disk / Cassette Tape	Personal archive. The label is in your handwriting.

READY TO PASTE

11. Content hooks: texts and logs

Tutorial narrator (FOREMAN)

Chapter-opening lines in FOREMAN's voice. The step texts that teach controls stay as they are; only intros and a few transitions change. Keys use the existing {key:...} tokens.

Chapter	Proposed FOREMAN line
First steps	Good morning, worker. Reconstruction successful. Your shift starts now. Move the mouse to look around.
Your toolbelt	Your Reclamation Kit is in the hotbar. Kestrel thanks you for not losing it yet.
Mining	This rock was once a planet. Please mine it responsibly. Hold {key:block_destroy} on an asteroid block.

Chapter	Proposed FOREMAN line
Smelting and crafting	The furnace turns ore into ingots. The handbook forbids smelting anything that is still moving.
Staying alive	Oxygen is not included in your contract. Melt ice into water, then make compressed oxygen.
Iron age and machines	Good work. You are now cleared for basic machines. Most workers never get this far.
Better drills	Deeper rock is harder rock. The core is down there somewhere. That is not a suggestion.
Build a base	Walls, air, a door. The Charter calls this a habitat. Workers call it home.
A second life (step)	The DNA reconstructor brings you back at your base when you die. The Cradle is very far away and it keeps count.
Your first ship	Anything you build in open space can fly. This is a feature, not a safety violation.
Beyond	Gravity generators need obscurium. Please do not ask where the last planet went.

Reconstruction and death screens

```
DNA RECONSTRUCTOR // CONTINUITY CHARTER UNIT
SUBJECT ........ KD-7731-VAREK, worker grade C
RECONSTRUCTION . #14
SEQUENCING DNA
RECONSTRUCTING SKELETAL STRUCTURE
GROWING MUSCLE TISSUE
RESTORING NERVOUS SYSTEM AND SKIN
RECONSTRUCTION COMPLETE. WELCOME BACK. PLEASE RESUME YOUR SHIFT.
```

- Death screen subtitle (random): *Body lost. Contract still valid. / The Charter thanks you for your sacrifice. / Please keep your DNA sample current. / Incident report filed automatically.*
- Button text: 'Respawn' becomes **Return to Cradle**; 'Reconstruct from DNA' stays.
- Header name: use the player name as the worker surname; the employee number can be a hash of it, the counter is the deaths statistic.

Derelict logs (signs, info panels, data tapes)

```
DATA TAPE // FOUND ON A SPACER, SHALLOWS
Day three after. Lowlight is gone. The sky is gone. The sea is floating
past the window in pieces the size of houses. I am keeping the beer.
```

```
INFO PANEL // LOWLIGHT HABITAT RING
REMINDER: Oxygen generators shut down if a door is left open.
This is not a fault. This is you.
```

```
SIGN // PAINTED ON A COMPACT CORVETTE HULL
OUR BODIES. OUR NAMES. OUR VEYRA.
```

```
DATA TAPE // KESTREL BIOLOGY DECK
Specimen L-four refuses to eat under lamps. Fed it a powered cell in
the dark: it ate the casing first, then the rock. It is not the rock
they want. It is what runs through it.
```

```
DATA TAPE // CRADLE MAINTENANCE LOG
Worker KD-7731 life signs lost. Archive integrity fair.
Initiating reconstruction. Note: this subject has been reconstructed
more times than the archive was rated for. Proceeding anyway.
```

```
INFO PANEL // DEEP TAP CONTROL, THE HEART
BORE DEPTH: ALL OF IT.
CORE RESPONSE: ANOMALOUS. SUPERVISOR NOTIFIED.
SUPERVISOR RESPONSE: KEEP DRILLING.
```

```
UNREADABLE PANEL // BUILDER CHAMBER
[=/ \=] |:| /=\ <:> ||= [/=\]
(FOREMAN: translation unavailable. This text predates Kestrel by an unknown margin.)
```

Small texts

Where	Text
Welcome screen, above the dev note	FOREMAN v2 online. Archive damaged. Worker reconstructed. Kestrel Deepworks wishes you a productive shift.
Loading screen tips	'Lights keep rockmites away.' / 'Ice is sea water. Sea water is oxygen.' / 'Keep a DNA sample near your reconstructor.' / 'The Registry always gets paid.'
Claim beacon window header	KESTREL CLAIMS REGISTRY. Site registered. Thank you for your payment.
Multiplayer join message	Another echo has woken: {name}.
First obscurium mined (chat)	FOREMAN: Obscurium detected. Handle with care. Rocks may follow you home.
First parasite killed (chat)	FOREMAN: Lithovore neutralised. Biology deck would have liked that one alive.
First death (chat after revival)	FOREMAN: Welcome back. The incident report has been filed under 'learning experience'.
Spacer interaction prompt	Search the body

ROADMAP

12. Suggested order of work

Ordered by value per effort. The first two stages are text and JSON only and already give the game a recognisable voice.

Stage	Work	Cost
1. Voice	FOREMAN tutorial intros, death and reconstruction screen texts, welcome memo, loading tips, claim window header, join message.	S
2. Lore lines	Optional Lore field for items, blocks and pictures (with default and a test using the description rule); fill the tables from section 10.	S to M
3. Found things	Data tapes and an employee tag in the spacer loot table; a small Cradle pod structure at the spawn point.	S to M
4. Derelicts	Fill abandoned_ship and ruins structures with signs, info panels, picture frames and crates; Compact and Kestrel variants.	M
5. Milestone messages	FOREMAN chat lines on PlayerActivity events (first obscurium, first death, first parasite, first ship flight).	M
6. Deep mysteries	Builder chambers (alien_base) in heavy asteroids in the Crush, radar derelict signals, readable log items and a journal.	L
7. The Heart	A unique core-fragment location at the belt centre and the hidden Chronicle chapter with the three endings.	L

Open decisions for the author

Decide: the planet and company names (Veyra, Ardent, Kestrel Deepworks, FOREMAN, Lowlight, the Crush) are placeholders. Decide: how dark the identity question should get (subtle counter only, or explicit spacer tags). Decide: whether the Builders should exist at all, or the Sundering stays a purely human mistake. Decide: which ending, if any, becomes canon for future GameSets.